

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will conduct research on a topic and present findings in a research paper and an oral presentation. Any secondary division contestant may enter this judged event. Contestants must be registered for the national competition before the submission deadline and compete in both parts of the event to be ranked. **Entries that do not follow the provided topic or the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines will be disqualified.**

Topic

Research how generative artificial intelligence (AI) is currently being integrated into administrative support roles. Explore how generative AI impacts efficiency, job responsibilities, data management, and communication. Consider both the opportunities and ethical concerns related to generative AI adoption. Offer recommendations for how administrative professionals can adapt to and thrive in a workplace where generative AI tools are increasingly common.

Points to consider:

- Historical Context & Evolution
- Types of Generative AI Used in Administrative Roles
- Productivity and Efficiency Gains
- Challenges and Limitations
- Ethical and Privacy Considerations
- Skills for the Future Administrative Professional
- Global and Cultural Considerations
- Training, Certification, and Professional Development
- Workplace Impacts
- Future Outlook

Contestant Must Supply

- Optional - Digital presentation tools and supporting equipment (device, software, projector, extension cords, etc.)

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged.
- Carry-in and set-up of equipment must be done solely by the contestant in the allotted time.
- No Internet access will be provided on-site at NLC; however, contestants may provide their own access to be used only for their presentation to the judges.
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than seven (7) minutes for the presentation, no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries.

Technical Pre-submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Naming Convention	National Deadline
Research Paper, Works Cited and BPA Release Form(s) in one combined PDF file.	ARPI-ContestantID.pdf	April 1, 2026, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

- Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of basic administrative support concepts by exploring and analyzing related issues
- Conduct research using various resources and methods
- Communicate research in a clear and concise manner both orally and in writing
- Analyze and discuss changes in the workplace
- Explore issues affecting the role of administrative support in the workplace
- Discuss findings and respond to questions
- Prepare a research paper using the report format found in the *Style & Reference Manual*
- Evaluate and make decisions based on research findings

Contest Specifications for this Event

- Follow the Report format in the *Style & Reference Manual* (no Title Page required). The header on the first page should include: Contestant ID Number (Sender's ID Number - XXXXXXXX), Edna Renick (Recipient's Name), Administrative Support Department (Recipient's Department), and Current Date.
- Document length is limited to seven double-spaced, single-sided, numbered pages with one-inch margins. The Works Cited page(s) is not included in this limit, but graphs, tables, and charts are. Judges will not read beyond the seven allowed pages.
- Each research paper must reflect the contestant's own research, writing, and original thinking.
- The research paper must be keyed/word-processed.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- This is a pre-submitted event. Regional and state conferences have specific deadlines prior to the national deadlines. Please consult the regional or state conference administrator for those deadlines. For the National Leadership Conference, submit the URL to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on April 1, 2026.
- Contestant ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered contestants and/or those missing Contestant ID cannot be accepted.
- The contestant is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including oneself, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The contestant is responsible for citing all sources, including oneself, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for copyright and/or fair use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

(260) Administrative Support Research Project

Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Contestant submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing their Research Paper and Works Cited in the correct format according to the <i>Style & Reference Guide</i> and BPA Release Form(s).				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10	Meets Expectations 11-20	Above Expectations 21-30	Points Awarded
Introduction & Summary	The introduction and summary lack clarity, with underdeveloped arguments and insufficient evidence.	The introduction and summary present a logical argument, with appropriate evidence supporting conclusions.	The introduction and summary are compelling, with strong evidence and a concise, impactful summary.	/30
Organization and Expansion of Ideas	The argument lacks structure, with weak transitions and underdeveloped ideas.	The argument is logical and coherent, with clear transitions and well-developed points.	The argument is well-organized, with smooth transitions and thoroughly expanded points, demonstrating clear reasoning.	/30
Comprehension of Topic	Shows limited understanding, with inaccuracies and shallow explanations. Ideas are unclear and poorly connected.	Demonstrates clear understanding with accurate explanations and relevant examples, with logical connections.	Exhibits deep understanding, explaining complex ideas clearly with insightful examples and thorough coverage.	/30
Creativity	The response lacks creativity, using generic ideas and limited resources.	The response is creative, offering an original perspective with diverse resources supporting the ideas.	The response is highly original and inventive, with well-integrated resources adding depth and creativity.	/30
Writing Accuracy	Frequent grammar or spelling errors.	Contains some grammar or spelling errors.	Contains very few or no grammar or spelling errors.	/30
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/160

(260) Administrative Support Research Project

Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.				☐ N ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Contestant rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Contestant occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Contestant maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	The presentation lacks coherence, and the contestant's approach does not clearly convey a structured or purposeful flow.	The presentation has some gaps in organization, and the contestant's structure is occasionally unclear or inconsistent.	The presentation content flows adequately, and the contestant demonstrates a clear and well-integrated structure throughout.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-30 points	Above Expectations 31-50 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic and includes mostly irrelevant or inaccurate information.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and includes a mix of relevant and irrelevant information.	Presentation demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and includes relevant and accurate information.	/50
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than seven (7) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATIONS POINTS				/100

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT SEVEN (7) MINUTES